

SiyaBusa ERP

COMPETITIVE BATTLE CARDS

Customer Success

Masaphokati Technologies (Pty) Ltd

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WE RULE. WE GOVERN. WE EMPOWER.

COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Battle cards for positioning against major ERP competitors.

Competitive Battle Cards

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How to Use Battle Cards

Purpose

Battle cards help sales teams quickly understand competitive positioning and respond effectively when prospects mention competitors.

Best Practices

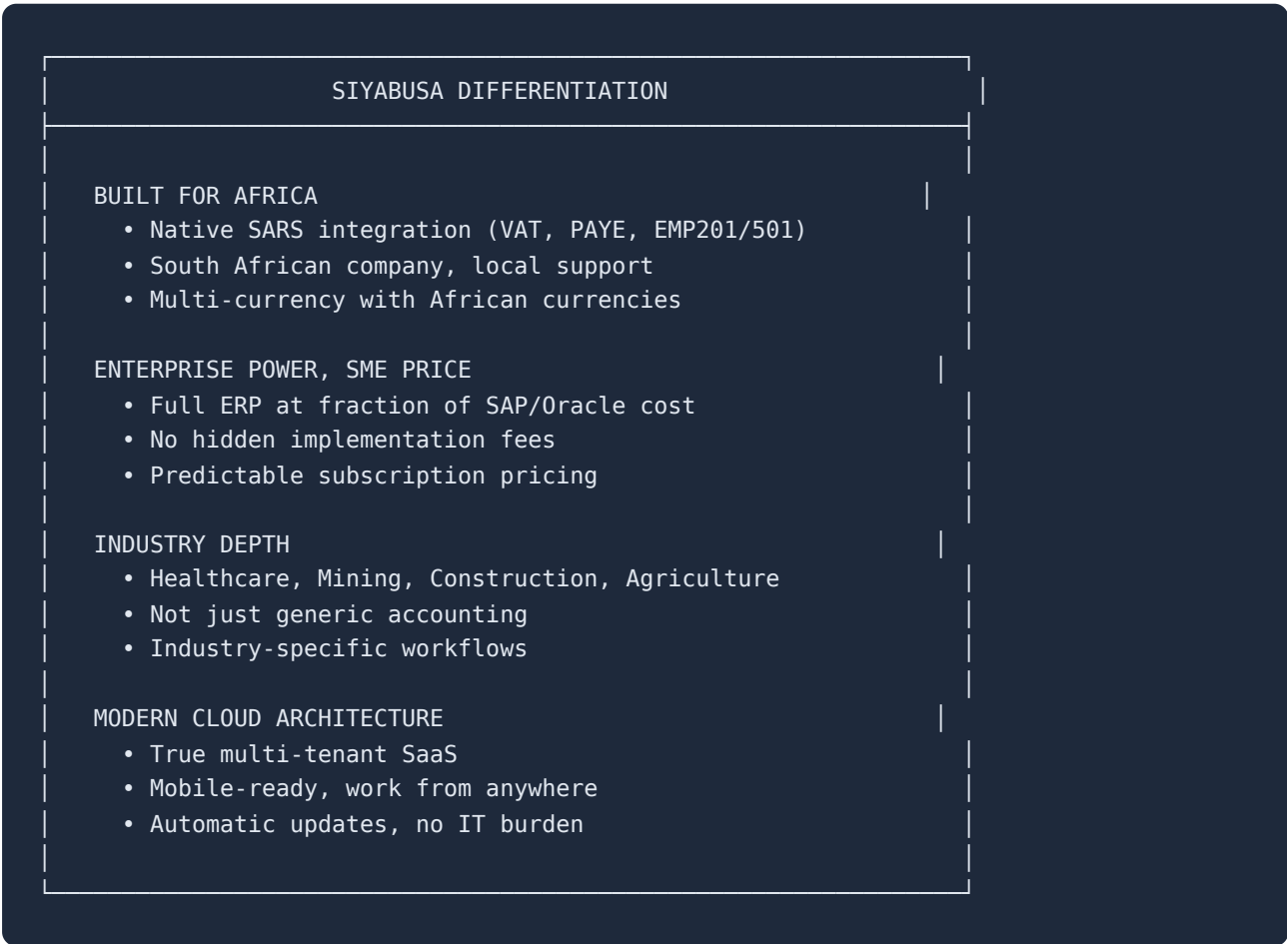
- **DO** focus on customer value, not competitor bashing
- **DO** acknowledge competitor strengths where appropriate
- **DO** use specific, verifiable differentiators
- **DO** pivot to customer needs and outcomes
- **DON'T** make false claims about competitors
- **DON'T** share battle cards with prospects
- **DON'T** lead with competitor weaknesses

Conversation Framework

1. ACKNOWLEDGE - "Yes, [Competitor] is a well-known solution..."
2. DIFFERENTIATE - "Where SiyaBusa differs is..."
3. PROVE - "For example, [Customer Name] chose us because..."
4. ASK - "What's most important to you in this decision?"

SiyaBusa Positioning

Our Unique Value Proposition



Key Differentiators Summary

Differentiator	Description
SARS Sentinel	Only ERP with automated SARS submission built-in
Audit Shield	Comprehensive audit trail and compliance
Industry Modules	Healthcare, Mining, Construction, Agriculture
African Focus	Built by Africans, for African businesses
All-In-One Price	No per-module licensing complexity

Battle Card: vs Sage

Competitor Overview

Aspect	Details
Company	Sage Group (UK-based, multinational)
Products	Sage 50, Sage 100, Sage 300, Sage X3, Sage Intacct
Target Market	SME to Mid-Market
Pricing	R500-R5,000/month depending on product
Strengths	Brand recognition, large user base, accountant familiarity

When You'll Encounter Sage

- Prospect using legacy Sage 50/Pastel
- Accountant recommendation
- Incumbent in established businesses

Competitive Positioning

Category	Sage	SiyaBusa	Advantage
SARS Integration	Manual/3rd party add-on	Built-in, automated	SiyaBusa
Cloud Native	Hybrid (legacy + cloud)	100% cloud	SiyaBusa
Industry Modules	Generic	Healthcare, Mining, Construction	SiyaBusa
Pricing Transparency	Complex tiers	All-inclusive	SiyaBusa
Brand Recognition	High	Growing	Sage
Accountant Familiarity	Very high	Moderate	Sage
Local Support	Call centers	Direct team	SiyaBusa

Sage Weaknesses to Highlight

1. **Legacy Architecture** - Many Sage products are desktop-first with cloud added later
2. **SARS Manual Process** - Requires manual export/import for tax submissions

3. **Module Complexity** - Need multiple products for full ERP functionality
4. **Hidden Costs** - Implementation, training, support often extra
5. **Upgrade Path** - Moving between Sage products is painful

Talking Points

When prospect says: "We've always used Sage"

"Sage has been a trusted name for decades. Many of our customers came from Sage because they needed true cloud access, built-in SARS integration, and industry-specific features that Sage couldn't provide without expensive add-ons. Would you like to see how we compare for your specific needs?"

When prospect says: "Our accountant uses Sage"

"We work seamlessly with external accountants. Our reports export in standard formats, and we can even give your accountant read-only access to review your books. Many accountants actually prefer SiyaBusa because the automated SARS submissions reduce their workload."

Win Story

"[Company Name] switched from Sage 300 to SiyaBusa and reduced their month-end close from 10 days to 3 days. Their SARS submissions that used to take hours are now automated. They're saving R50,000/year in software and support costs."

Battle Card: vs SAP Business One

Competitor Overview

Aspect	Details
Company	SAP SE (Germany, enterprise giant)
Product	SAP Business One (B1)
Target Market	SME/Mid-Market (50-500 employees)
Pricing	R150,000-R500,000+ implementation + R3,000-R10,000/user/month
Strengths	Enterprise pedigree, extensive functionality, global presence

When You'll Encounter SAP B1

- Growing companies thinking "enterprise"
- Subsidiaries of larger organizations
- Complex manufacturing requirements

Competitive Positioning

Category	SAP B1	SiyaBusa	Advantage
Implementation Cost	R150K-R500K+	R20K-R50K	SiyaBusa
Time to Value	3-6 months	2-4 weeks	SiyaBusa
Total Cost of Ownership	Very high	Moderate	SiyaBusa
SARS Integration	Add-on required	Built-in	SiyaBusa
Manufacturing Depth	Deep	Strong	SAP
Global Scalability	Excellent	Good	SAP
Ease of Use	Complex	Intuitive	SiyaBusa
Local Customization	Partner dependent	In-house	SiyaBusa

SAP B1 Weaknesses to Highlight

1. **Cost Prohibitive** - Total cost often exceeds R1M for SME

2. **Long Implementation** - 3-6 months average, delays common
3. **Over-Engineered** - Complex for mid-market needs
4. **Partner Dependency** - Reliant on implementation partners
5. **Slow Updates** - Annual release cycle

Talking Points

When prospect says: "We want SAP for the brand"

"SAP's reputation is well-earned for large enterprises. For mid-market companies in South Africa, we often find the implementation cost alone exceeds the total 5-year cost of SiyaBusa. Our customers get 80% of SAP's functionality at 20% of the cost. Would you like to see a TCO comparison?"

When prospect says: "SAP will scale as we grow"

"That's a valid consideration. SiyaBusa is built on modern cloud architecture that scales automatically. Many of our customers have grown from 10 to 200+ users without outgrowing our platform. And if you ever do need enterprise SAP, the data migration is straightforward."

Win Story

"[Company Name] was quoted R450,000 for SAP Business One implementation plus R8,000/user/month. They chose SiyaBusa at R35,000 implementation and R12,000/month total. They went live in 3 weeks instead of 4 months. After 2 years, they've saved over R800,000."

Battle Card: vs QuickBooks

Competitor Overview

Aspect	Details
Company	Intuit (US-based)
Products	QuickBooks Online, QuickBooks Desktop
Target Market	Micro to Small businesses (1-25 employees)
Pricing	R200-R1,500/month
Strengths	Easy to use, affordable, widely known

When You'll Encounter QuickBooks

- Startups and small businesses
- Businesses that have outgrown spreadsheets
- Price-sensitive prospects

Competitive Positioning

Category	QuickBooks	SiyaBusa	Advantage
Accounting	Good	Comprehensive	Similar
Inventory Management	Basic	Advanced (multi-warehouse)	SiyaBusa
Manufacturing/BOM	None	Full MRP	SiyaBusa
HR/Payroll	Limited/Add-on	Integrated	SiyaBusa
SARS Integration	None	Built-in	SiyaBusa
Industry Modules	None	Healthcare, Mining, etc.	SiyaBusa
Ease of Use	Very easy	Easy	QuickBooks
Entry Price	Low	Moderate	QuickBooks

QuickBooks Weaknesses to Highlight

1. **Limited Scalability** - Struggles past 25 users or complex inventory

2. **No SARS Integration** - Manual tax processes required
3. **Basic Inventory** - Single location, no BOM support
4. **US-Centric** - Built for US market, adapted for SA
5. **Add-On Dependency** - Core product limited, needs apps

Talking Points

When prospect says: "QuickBooks is cheaper"

"For basic accounting, QuickBooks is hard to beat on price. Where we see customers outgrow QuickBooks is when they need multi-warehouse inventory, manufacturing, HR/payroll, or SARS automation. By the time you add those capabilities to QuickBooks, SiyaBusa is often more cost-effective and better integrated."

When prospect says: "We just need simple accounting"

"If your needs are truly simple, QuickBooks might work for now. Most businesses grow, though. When you need inventory management, employee payroll, or VAT submissions, you'll face a painful migration. SiyaBusa grows with you—start simple, add complexity as needed."

Win Story

"[Company Name] used QuickBooks for 3 years until they opened a second warehouse. They needed real-time inventory across locations and integrated payroll. Migration to SiyaBusa took 1 week, and they now manage 3 warehouses and 45 employees on one platform."

Battle Card: vs Xero

Competitor Overview

Aspect	Details
Company	Xero (New Zealand-based)
Product	Xero Accounting
Target Market	Small businesses, accountant-led
Pricing	R300-R800/month
Strengths	Beautiful UI, accountant marketplace, bank feeds

When You'll Encounter Xero

- Modern, tech-savvy small businesses
- Businesses with external accountants
- Professional services firms

Competitive Positioning

Category	Xero	SiyaBusa	Advantage
User Interface	Excellent	Very Good	Xero
Bank Feeds	Excellent	Good	Xero
Inventory	Basic	Advanced	SiyaBusa
Manufacturing	None	Full	SiyaBusa
HR/Payroll	Limited (Payspace addon)	Integrated	SiyaBusa
SARS Integration	None	Built-in	SiyaBusa
Project Costing	Basic	Advanced	SiyaBusa
Multi-Entity	Limited	Full consolidation	SiyaBusa

Xero Weaknesses to Highlight

1. **Accounting Only** - Not a true ERP, just accounting

2. **No SARS** - Relies on 3rd party integrations
3. **Inventory Limitations** - Basic, no multi-warehouse
4. **Add-On Complexity** - Need multiple apps for full solution
5. **Not Built for Africa** - AU/NZ focus

Talking Points

When prospect says: "Xero has the best interface"

"Xero's design is definitely modern and clean. We've invested heavily in making SiyaBusa intuitive as well. The key difference is what happens when you need more than accounting—inventory, payroll, SARS submissions. With Xero, you're managing multiple apps. With SiyaBusa, it's all integrated."

When prospect says: "My accountant recommends Xero"

"Many accountants love Xero for pure accounting. If you need inventory management, manufacturing, or integrated HR, ask your accountant how they'd handle that with Xero. Usually it means multiple disconnected apps. SiyaBusa gives you and your accountant one unified system."

Battle Card: vs Pastel/Sage Accounting

Competitor Overview

Aspect	Details
Company	Sage (formerly Softline Pastel)
Products	Pastel Partner, Pastel Xpress, Sage Business Cloud Accounting
Target Market	Micro to Small businesses in SA
Pricing	R200-R2,000/month
Strengths	SA market dominance, accountant installed base

When You'll Encounter Pastel

- Almost every South African SME
- Accountant recommendations
- Legacy system upgrades

Competitive Positioning

Category	Pastel	SiyaBusa	Advantage
SA Market Share	Dominant	Growing	Pastel
Desktop/Cloud	Both (fragmented)	100% Cloud	SiyaBusa
SARS Integration	Manual/Basic	Automated	SiyaBusa
Multi-User	Limited (desktop)	Unlimited	SiyaBusa
Industry Modules	Generic	Specialized	SiyaBusa
Manufacturing	Separate product	Integrated	SiyaBusa
Accountant Familiarity	Very High	Moderate	Pastel

Pastel Weaknesses to Highlight

1. **Fragmented Products** - Desktop vs Cloud are different products
2. **Desktop Dependency** - Many users still on desktop versions
3. **Limited Cloud Functionality** - Cloud version less capable than desktop
4. **Upgrade Complexity** - Moving from desktop to cloud is difficult
5. **Per-Company Licensing** - Multi-entity gets expensive

Talking Points

When prospect says: "Everyone uses Pastel in SA"

"Pastel has been the default choice for decades, and for good reason in the past. The market is shifting to cloud-first solutions with automated compliance. Many businesses are finding that Pastel's cloud offering doesn't have the depth they need, while SiyaBusa was built cloud-native from day one."

When prospect says: "We've used Pastel for years"

"Your Pastel experience will actually make SiyaBusa feel familiar—similar accounting concepts, just modernized for the cloud. The big differences you'll notice are automated SARS submissions, real-time multi-user access, and integrated modules that Pastel charges separately for."

Battle Card: vs Microsoft Dynamics

Competitor Overview

Aspect	Details
Company	Microsoft Corporation
Products	Dynamics 365 Business Central, Dynamics 365 Finance
Target Market	Mid-Market to Enterprise
Pricing	R1,500-R3,500/user/month + implementation
Strengths	Microsoft ecosystem, Office integration, Azure platform

When You'll Encounter Dynamics

- Microsoft shops (Office 365, Azure)
- Mid-market companies wanting "one vendor"
- IT-led purchasing decisions

Competitive Positioning

Category	Dynamics 365	SiyaBusa	Advantage
Microsoft Integration	Native	API-based	Dynamics
Implementation Cost	High (R200K+)	Moderate	SiyaBusa
Complexity	High	Moderate	SiyaBusa
SARS Integration	Partner add-on	Built-in	SiyaBusa
Local Support	Partner network	Direct	SiyaBusa
Industry Modules	Generic	SA-specific	SiyaBusa
Enterprise Scale	Yes	Yes	Similar

Dynamics Weaknesses to Highlight

1. **Cost Structure** - Per-user licensing adds up quickly
2. **Implementation Complexity** - Requires certified partners
3. **Over-Featured** - Built for global enterprise, not SA mid-market
4. **SARS Gap** - No native SA tax integration
5. **Support Layers** - Microsoft → Partner → Customer

Talking Points

When prospect says: "We're a Microsoft shop"

"We understand the value of ecosystem consistency. SiyaBusa integrates with Microsoft 365 via APIs—your data flows to Excel, Power BI, and Outlook seamlessly. Where we add value is SA-specific features like SARS Sentinel that Dynamics would require expensive customization to match."

Battle Card: vs Syspro

Competitor Overview

Aspect	Details
Company	Syspro (SA-founded, now global)
Product	Syspro ERP
Target Market	Manufacturing & Distribution
Pricing	R100,000+ implementation + R2,000-R5,000/user/month
Strengths	Manufacturing depth, SA heritage, distribution focus

When You'll Encounter Syspro

- Manufacturers and distributors
- Companies with complex supply chains
- Legacy ERP replacement projects

Competitive Positioning

Category	Syspro	SiyaBusa	Advantage
Manufacturing Depth	Very Deep	Deep	Syspro
SA Compliance	Good	Excellent	SiyaBusa
Implementation Cost	High	Moderate	SiyaBusa
Cloud Native	Hybrid	100% Cloud	SiyaBusa
Time to Value	Months	Weeks	SiyaBusa
Industry Verticals	Manufacturing	Multiple	SiyaBusa
SME Fit	Over-engineered	Right-sized	SiyaBusa

Syspro Weaknesses to Highlight

1. **Over-Engineered for SME** - Built for larger manufacturers
2. **Implementation Heavy** - Long, expensive implementations

- 3. **Legacy Architecture** - Not cloud-native
- 4. **Limited Verticals** - Manufacturing focus limits flexibility
- 5. **Cost** - Enterprise pricing for mid-market

Talking Points

When prospect says: "We need manufacturing ERP"

"Syspro is excellent for complex manufacturing. For most SA manufacturers, SiyaBusa provides the manufacturing depth you need—BOM, work orders, MRP—at a fraction of the cost and implementation time. Let's map your manufacturing requirements to see which is the better fit."

Objection Handling Across Competitors

Common Objections & Responses

Objection	Response
"You're not well known"	"We're growing rapidly because we solve real problems that established players ignore—like automated SARS submissions. Would you rather have brand familiarity or actual functionality?"
"My accountant hasn't heard of you"	"We'd be happy to demo for your accountant. Many accountants become advocates once they see the SARS automation alone."
"What if you go out of business?"	"We're backed by Masaphokati Technologies, a profitable SA company. Your data is yours—we provide full exports anytime. Compare that to Sage's track record of discontinuing products."
"Competitor has more features"	"Let's identify the features you actually use. Most ERP customers use 20% of features. We focus on the 20% that matters most for SA businesses."
"I need to involve IT"	"Great, we love working with IT teams. SiyaBusa is cloud-native, so there's no infrastructure to manage. IT typically appreciates the reduced burden."

Win/Loss Analysis

Track Competitive Wins & Losses

Date	Company	Competitor	Outcome	Key Factor
[Date]	[Company]	Sage	Win	SARS automation
[Date]	[Company]	SAP B1	Win	Cost/time to value
[Date]	[Company]	QuickBooks	Win	Inventory needs
[Date]	[Company]	Syspro	Loss	Manufacturing depth
[Date]	[Company]	Dynamics	Win	Local support

Win Themes

1. **SARS Integration** - #1 differentiator
2. **Cost/Value** - Enterprise features, SME price
3. **Time to Value** - Weeks not months
4. **Local Support** - Direct relationship

Loss Themes

1. **Brand Familiarity** - Prospect wants "safe" choice
2. **Manufacturing Depth** - Very complex requirements
3. **Incumbent Relationship** - Switching cost too high

Document Control

Version	Date	Author	Changes
1.0	January 2026	Sales	Initial release

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